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Hiring Team
KAYAK
Berlin, Germany

Berlin, November 4, 2026

Application for Data Scientist

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Data Scientist position at KAYAK. I have a Master's in Artificial Intelligence and three years of experience building and deploying AI applications, and I would like to apply the modelling side of that work to your recommendation systems.

At Covestro I built and compared Random Forest, XGBoost and LSTM models on sensor time series. I engineered lag features and rolling windows, benchmarked the models against the empirical curve-fitting the chemists used, and put the predictions into a Streamlit dashboard so they could test parameter changes before running a batch. At Cognizant I developed ARIMA, SARIMA, Prophet and LSTM models for EV load forecasting. In both jobs the task was to turn a business question into a measurable modelling problem, which is how your posting describes the role.

Evaluation is where most of my recent work sits. For my Master's thesis I benchmarked multilingual embedding models on more than one million text chunks with PyTorch and Hugging Face tooling, using retrieval metrics against chemist-provided ground truth. At Kniit I was the sole developer of a knowledge-extraction pipeline and raised its precision and recall from 33%/45% to 93%/90%, working directly with the CTO and with domain experts. I should say plainly that I have not yet built a production recommender or run online A/B tests in a job. I know the methods, and I am open about where I would still be learning.

KAYAK appeals to me because the recommendation problem is concrete: travellers choose among many options, and every ranking change shows up in the numbers. Being part of Booking Holdings while building products as KAYAK for Business suggests there is room to ship ideas and see their effect quickly.

I am based in Berlin, hold an EU Blue Card, and can start on 15 November 2026. I am comfortable with three office days per week. Thank you for considering my application. I would be glad to talk about how I could contribute.

Kind regards,

Chandu Prasad Bhairapu